Jig

Players: 4, 6, or 8 | **Ages:** 12+ | **Time:** 15–30 mins

Getting started

Overview

Jig is a competitive game of memory, deduction, and revenge! Fish for cards from the opposing team, paying attention to what other players ask for and what they get. When you think your team has all the cards of one colour, you can "land" them — but you must know exactly who has which card, or else the other team steals the point!

Contents

54 playing cards (nine coloured sets, numbered 1 to 6) and one dory card.

Setup

Form two equal teams and sit in alternating order around the table. Place the dory in the middle of the table. Choose the colours you will play with (see recommendations below) and set any remaining cards aside.

	Beginner	**Advanced**
4 players	5 colours	7 colours
6, 8 players	7 colours	9 colours

Shuffle the deck and deal all cards to the players. In a 4-player game, deal a dummy hand for the Skipper, who acts as a member of both teams. Keep hands secret — no table talk! Choose a starting player randomly.

Gameplay

Fishing for cards

On your turn, choose any opposing player and ask them for a specific card.

> *Ex. "John: Do you have the red 2?"*

- If they have the card, they give it to you; it is now your turn again.
- If they do not have the card, it is now their turn.

You must obey the following three rules:

- **Colour rule:** You cannot ask for a card if you have no cards of that colour.
- **No bluffing:** You cannot ask for a card if you already have that card.
- **No empty turns:** You cannot ask a player who has no cards left.

You can ask any opponent, even the same person multiple times in a row. Players cannot hide how many cards they have. Pause briefly between turns to allow players to optionally "land a set".

Landing a set

If you think your team has all the cards of one colour, you can try to land the set — even if it's not your turn, and even if you have no cards left.

1. Declare: Interrupt the game between any two turns by grabbing the dory and placing it in front of the next player before they start their turn. Declare the colour you want to land. *Note: Multiple sets can be landed in the same interruption. Whoever grabs the dory first proceeds.*

2. Locate: With no help from your teammates, locate all six cards by identifying which member of your team holds each specific card.

> *Ex. "We have the reds. I have the 3, 5, 6; Lisa has the 1 and 4; Aidan has the 2."*

> *Ex. (4-player game) "We have the reds. I have the 3, 5, 6; Lisa has the 1 and 4; the Skipper has the 2."*

3. Reveal: Players from both teams reveal all cards of the declared colour. *Note: In a 4-player game, never look at the Skipper's hand; you can assume it contains all unrevealed cards.*

- If you correctly located all six cards, your team gets a point.
- If you made any mistakes, the other team gets the point.

> *Ex. If you say "Lisa has the red 1" and she does not — because a teammate or an opponent has it — the opposing team scores the point.*

4. Reset: Give the revealed cards to the scoring team and return the dory to the middle of the table. Play resumes with the player whose turn was next. If that player is now out of cards, play passes to the teammate on their left. If an entire team is out of cards, see "End of game."

End of game

The game ends when all sets have been scored. If one team runs out of cards before this happens, then the other team cannot ask any more questions (*No empty turns*). With no table talk, they must try to land their remaining sets in the usual way. The team with the most points wins!

Extras

Strategy notes

- You can (and should) ask for cards that have been taken from you! But if you lose all your cards of one colour, you can never get them back (*Colour rule*).
- You can make deductions about who has which cards, because players must follow the *Colour rule* and *No bluffing*.

> *Ex. You have the blue 5 and blue 6. John asks you for the blue 1. It is now your turn and you know that John has at least one of the blue 2, blue 3, or blue 4.*

Shark rule (optional)

At the start of the game, players can decide to play with this additional rule: if you think the opposing team has all six cards of one colour, you can try to land their set before they do. *Note: You cannot use the Shark rule if your team is out of cards.*

1. Declare: Interrupt an opponent after they choose who to ask, but before they ask for a card. (This ensures the other team has the first chance to land their own set, before the turn is started.) Place the dory in front of the interrupted player. Declare the colour you want to land.

2. Locate: Identify which player on the opposing team has each card of the set. *Note: In a 4-player game, this can include the Skipper.*

Follow steps 3 and 4 from "Landing a set" as usual. The interrupted player restarts their turn and may ask a different player.